

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FOR JUN 18

This test is based on The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (IRPCS) (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol II, IALA Maritime Buoyage System (NP735) and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck Officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST Navigation Staff. The exam should take no longer than 1hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

PART 1

1. Define a “vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre” (R.3g) **(2)**
2. The term “vessel restricted in their ability” to manoeuvre shall include but not be limited to..... (R.3g) **(3)**
3. What is meant by the term “restricted visibility?” (R.3l) **(1)**

4. How and when should a look-out be maintained? (R.5) **(2)**

5. In determining if risk of collision exists the following considerations shall be among those taken into account:..... (R7.d) **(2)**

6. The Rules governing lookout, safe speed, risk of collision, action to avoid collision, narrow channels and TSS apply in what condition of visibility?(R4) **(1)**

7. What do the Rules say with regards to anchoring in a narrow channel? (R.9g) **(1)**

8. What should a vessel do when nearing a bend or intervening obstruction in a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9f) **(2)**

9. Describe the sound signals a vessel intending to overtake another on her port side in a narrow channel or fairway should make. (R.9e(i) R.34c(i)) **(1)**

10. What sound signals would the vessel to be overtaken make if in agreement? (R.9e(i) R.34 c(ii)) **(1)**

11. A vessel which, by any of these rules , is required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel shall....what? (R. 8f(i)) **(2)**

12. What shall alterations of course and / or speed to avoid collision be? (R.8b) **(2)**

13. In restricted visibility, except where it has been determined that a risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close-quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam shall do what? (R.19e) **(3)**

14. Rule 2a refers to the ordinary practice of seaman; give two examples of what is meant by this term. **(2)**

15. Give two examples of a vessel not under command. (R.3f) **(2)**

Part 1 ____/26

PART 2

You are in your first complement assignment as OOW4 serving in HMS DUNCAN (length 152.4m). The CO has granted your PE having achieved all the pre-requisites during your recent BOST. You have sailed from HMNB PORTSMOUTH on a beautiful Monday morning for your deployment to the Mediterranean to operate in company with SNMG units.

16. Due to the good weather a high number of sailing vessels and small pleasure craft (less than 20m length) are operating in the Solent. As you are in a narrow channel, what is required of these vessels regarding your passage? (R9b) **(1)**

17. There is a small pleasure craft that appears to be moving very slowly towards you and has a CPA of less than 2c. You are not sure of her intention, what should you do? If (R34d) **(1)**

18. You manage to make it through the array of vessels and SSD fall out. You return for the dogs – your first solo watch. The SPC reports a Merchant Vessel at Red 150 overtaking you with a CPA of 5c on your port quarter. How do the Rules define overtaking? (R13b) **(1)**

19. It appears the vessel is heading for the OFF CASQUETS TSS. How will you expect her to join the appropriate lane in the TSS?(R10c(iii)) **(2)**

20. You sight one of the cross channel ferries at Green 30 at 5nm (you are on their port bow) she has a CPA of 2c ahead of the Ship. What situation is developing and what action is required of you?(R15) **(2)**

21. You sight a sailing vessel at Red 15 at 4nm. You are 130 degrees on her starboard bow with a CPA of 1c on your port bow. What RoR situation could this be classed as? (R.13) **(1)**

22. As you get closer, you sight a conical shape in the fore-rigging with the apex pointing down. The sailing vessel suddenly turns and you are now 45 degrees on her starboard bow with a CPA of 3c. Does this mean the RoR situation has now changed and who is responsible for keeping out of the way? (R.13d) **(2)**

23. You detect a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre that appears to be replacing a buoy near the start of the TSS. What do the Rules say regarding such a vessel obeying the rules for TSS? (R.10k) **(1)**

24. You pass through the TSS without incident but as you exit the TSS, you notice that the visibility is starting to reduce. What do the Rules say about safe speed in reduced visibility? (R19b) **(2)**

25. Your current SOA to RV with a group of French warships is 18kts. What factors (irrespective of your radar performance) will you be taking into account when making your recommendation of safe speed to the CO?(R6a) **(3)**

26. You detect a contact on radar fine on the starboard bow at 5nm. Describe your actions and what you must avoid? (R19d) **(3)**

27. You finally pass this contact – a power driven vessel of at least 100m. Describe the lights, arcs of visibility and minimum detection ranges you expect her to display at night?(R21 & R22a) **(6)**

Part 2 ____/24
Total ____/51

PART 1 - ANSWERS

1. Define a vessel *restricted in her ability to manoeuvre* (R.3g) (1)

The term *vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre* means a vessel which from the nature of her work is restricted in her ability to manoeuvre as required by these rules and is therefore unable to keep out of the way of another vessel.

2. The term *vessel restricted in their ability to manoeuvre* shall include but not be limited to..... (R.3g) (3)

1/2 mark for each

- i. a vessel engaged in laying, service or picking up a navigation mark, submarine cable or pipeline;
- ii. a vessel engaged in dredging, surveying or underwater operations;
- iii. a vessel engaged in replenishment of transferring persons, provisions or cargo while underway;
- iv. a vessel engaged in the launching or recovery of aircraft;
- v. a vessel engaged in mine clearance operations;
- vi. a vessel engaged in a towing operation such as severely restricts the towing vessel and her tow in their ability to deviate from their course

3. What is meant by the term *restricted visibility*? (R.3I) (1)

The term *restricted visibility* means any condition in which visibility is restricted by fog, mist, falling snow, heavy rainstorms, sandstorms or any other similar causes.

4. How and when should a look-out be maintained? (R.5) (2)

Every vessel shall at all times maintain a proper look-out by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate in the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision.

5. In determining if risk of collision exists the following considerations shall be among those taken into account:..... (R7.d) (2)

- i. such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change;
- ii. such risk may sometimes exist even when an appreciable bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or a tow or when approaching a vessel at close range.

6. The rules governing lookout, safe speed, risk of collision, action to avoid collision, narrow channels and TSS apply in what condition of visibility? (R.4) (1)

Rules in this section apply in any condition of visibility

7. What do the Rules say with regards to anchoring in a narrow channel? (R.9g) (1)

Any vessel shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid anchoring in a narrow channel.

8. What should a vessel do when nearing a bend or intervening obstruction in a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9f) (2)

A vessel nearing a bend or an area of a narrow channel or fairway where other vessels may be obscured by an intervening obstruction shall navigate with particular alertness and caution and shall sound the appropriate signal prescribed in rule 34(e).

9. Describe the sound signals a vessel intending to overtake another on her port side in a narrow channel or fairway should make. (R.9e(i) R.34c(i)) **(1)**

Two prolonged blasts followed by two short blasts

10. What sound signals would the vessel to be overtaken make if in agreement? (R.9e(i) R.34 c(ii)) **(1)**

One prolonged, one short, one prolonged and one short blast, in that order.

11. A vessel which, by any of these rules, is required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel shall....what? (R. 8f(i)) **(2)**

A vessel which, by any of these rules, is required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel shall, when required by the circumstances of the case, take early action to allow sufficient sea room for the safe passage of the other vessel.

12. What shall alterations of course and / or speed to avoid collision be? (R.8b) **(2)**

Any alteration of course and / or speed to avoid collision shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, be large enough to be readily apparent to another vessel observing visually or by radar; a succession of small alterations of course and / or speed should be avoided.

13. In restricted visibility, except where it has been determined that a risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close-quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam shall do what? (R.19e) **(3)**

....shall reduce her speed to the minimum at which she can be kept on her course. She shall if necessary take all her way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until danger of collision is over.

14. Rule 2a refers to the ordinary practice of seaman; give two examples of what is meant by this term. **(2)**

Any 2 suitable suggestions including the following:

- i. **A vessel underway should keep clear of a vessel at anchor.**
- ii. **A vessel anchoring should keep clear of other vessels at anchor and should not endanger the safe navigation of other vessels.**
- iii. **A vessel without an operational radar should go to anchor in restricted visibility.**
- iv. **When proceeding up a tidal channel, the vessel proceeding against the tidal flow should give way to/wait for the vessel proceeding with the tidal flow.**
- v. **Consideration should always be given to shallow water effects and particularly the impact of those on nearby vessels.**
- vi. **Rule 10 should be followed in TSS not adopted by the IMO.**

15. Give two examples of a vessel not under command. (R.3f) **(2)**

A vessel experiencing a total electrical failure.

A vessel dragging its anchor.

A sailing vessel becalmed.

A vessel which has lost its steering gear.

PART 2- ANSWERS

You are in your first complement assignment as OOW4 serving in HMS DUNCAN (length 152.4m). The CO has granted your PE having achieved all the pre-requisites during your recent BOST. You have sailed from HMNB PORTSMOUTH on a beautiful Monday morning for your deployment to the Mediterranean to operate in company with SNMG units.

16. Due to the good weather a high number of sailing vessels and small pleasure craft (less than 20m length) are operating in the Solent. As you are in a narrow channel, what is required of these vessels regarding your passage? (R9b) (1)

A vessel of less than 20 metres in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway

17. There is a small pleasure craft that appears to be moving very slowly towards you and has a CPA of less than 2c. You are not sure of her intention, what should you do? If (R34d) (1)

When vessels in sight of one another are approaching each other and from any cause either fails to understand the intentions or actions of the other, or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blasts on the whistle. Such signal may be supplemented by light signal of at least five short and rapid flashes.

18. You manage to make it through the array of vessels and SSD fall out. You return for the dogs – your first solo watch. The SPC reports a Merchant Vessel at Red 150 overtaking you with a CPA of 5c on your port quarter. How do the Rules define overtaking? (R13b) (1)

A vessel shall be deemed to be overtaking when coming up with another vessel from a direction more than 22.5 degrees abaft her beam, that is, in such a position with reference to the vessel she is overtaking, that at night she would be able to see only the sternlight of that vessel but neither of her sidelights.

19. It appears the vessel is heading for the OFF CASQUETS TSS. How should she join the appropriate lane in the TSS? (R10c(iii)) (2)

Normally join or leave a traffic lane at the termination of the lane, but when joining or leaving from either side shall do so at as small an angle to the general direction of traffic flow as practicable.

20. You sight one of the cross channel ferries at Green 30 at 5nm (you are on their port bow) she has a CPA of 2c ahead of the Ship. What situation is developing and what action is required of you? (R.15) (2)

Crossing Situation

When two power driven vessels are crossing so as to involve risk of collision, the vessel which has the other on her own starboard side shall keep out of the way and shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid crossing ahead of the other vessel.

21. You sight a sailing vessel at Red 15 at 4nm. You are 130 degrees on her starboard bow with a CPA of 1c on your port bow. What RoR situation could this be classed as? (R.13) (1)

Overtaking situation

22. As you get closer, you sight a conical shape in the fore-rigging with the apex pointing down. The sailing vessel suddenly turns and you are now 45 degrees on her starboard bow with a CPA of

3c. Does this mean the RoR situation has now changed and who is responsible for keeping out of the way? (R.13d) (2)

Any subsequent alteration of the bearing between the two vessels shall not make the overtaking vessel a crossing vessel within the meaning of these Rules or relieve her of the duty of keeping clear of the overtaken vessel until she is finally past and clear.

We are still responsible for keeping clear.

23. You detect a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre that appears to be replacing a buoy near the start of the TSS. What do the Rules say regarding such a vessel obeying the rules for TSS? (R.10k) (1)

A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre when engaged in an operation for the maintenance of safety of navigation in a traffic separation scheme is exempted from complying with this Rule to the extent necessary to carry out the operation.

24. You pass through the TSS without incident but as you exit the TSS, you notice that the visibility is starting to reduce. What do the Rules say about safe speed in reduced visibility? (R19b) (2)

Every vessel shall proceed at a safe speed adapted to the prevailing circumstances and conditions of restricted visibility. A power driven vessel shall have her engines ready for immediate manoeuvre.

25. Your current SOA to RV with a group of French warships is 18kts. What factors (irrespective of your radar performance) will you be taking into account when making your recommendation of safe speed to the CO? (R6a) (3)

Half mark for each one.

In determining a safe speed the following factors shall be among those taken into account:

By all vessels:

- (i) the state of visibility;
- (ii) the traffic density including concentrations of fishing vessels or any other vessels;
- (iii) the manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions;
- (iv) at night the presence of background light such as from shore lights or from backscatter of her own lights;
- (v) the state of wind, sea and current, and the proximity of navigational hazards;
- (vi) the draught in relation to the available depth of water.

26. You detect a contact on radar fine on the starboard bow at 5nm. Describe your actions and what you must avoid? (R19d) (3)

A vessel which detects by radar alone the presence of another vessel shall determine if a close quarters situation is developing and/or risk of collision exists. If so, she shall take avoiding action in ample time, provided that when such action consists of an alteration of course, so far as possible the following shall be avoided:

- (i) **an alteration of course to port for a vessel forward of the beam, other than for a vessel being overtaken;**

27. You finally pass this contact – a power driven vessel of at least 100m. Describe the lights, arcs of visibility and minimum detection ranges you expect her to display at night? (R21 & R22a) (6)

“Masthead light” means a white light placed over the fore and aft centreline of the vessel showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 225 degrees and so fixed as to show the light from right ahead to 22.5 degrees abaft the beam on either side of the vessel.

“Sidelights” means a green light on the starboard side and a red light on the port side each showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 112.5 degrees and so fixed as to show the light from right ahead to 22.5 degrees abaft the beam on its respective side. In a vessel of less than 20 metres in length the sidelights may be combined in one lantern carried on the fore and aft centreline of the vessel.

“Sternlight” means a white light placed as nearly as practicable at the stern showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 135 degrees and so fixed as to show the light 67.5 degrees from right aft on each side of the vessel.

The lights prescribed in these Rules shall have an intensity as specified in section 8 of Annex I to these Regulations so as to be visible at the following minimum ranges:

In vessels of 50 metres or more in length:

a masthead light, 6 miles;

a sidelight, 3 miles;

a sternlight, 3 miles;

Part 2 ____/25
Total ____/51